



Quaker Springs Fire District #1
107 Blodgett Road
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Schuylerville, NY 12871
518-584-3349

Social Media Policy

AUTHORITY:

The Board of Fire Commissioners ("Board") of Quaker Springs Fire District #1 established the following policy on Social Media use. The Board's authority to manage Social Media use is derived under subdivisions (11) and (21) of Town Law Section 176 and subdivision (e) paragraph (1) of Not-for-Profit Corporation Law Section 1402.

PURPOSE:

The purpose of this policy is to address the use and manner of appearance or the presence of Quaker Springs Fire District #1 (Fire District), and Quaker Springs Volunteer Fire Department, Inc. (referred to hereinafter as "Fire Department" or Fire Company) or any assumed name, alias, abbreviation, or derivation thereof of either entity. It is the responsibility of all members of the Fire Department and Fire District to comply with the Board of Fire Commissioners' rules and regulations as set forth in this Policy to protect the good name and reputation of the Fire District and the Fire Department, other fire service agencies and organizations, and the volunteer fire service in general when using social media or on internet web sites. It is the intent of this Policy to establish minimum standards for the posting of information by Fire Department members of any membership classification regarding the Fire Department and Fire District, their operations, affiliations, and mission. The intent of this Policy is to project positive images of both the Fire District and Fire Department organizations, to assure that postings connected directly or indirectly to either organization display age appropriate and community-oriented content and public safety information to the general public, and to insure that the generational integrity and favorable reputations of the Fire District and Fire Department are neither intentionally or unintentionally impugned or compromised by the social media presence of members of the Fire Department.

Pursuant to this Policy, each member of the Fire Department acknowledges that their individual affiliation with the two organizations provides them access to information and places not otherwise accessible to civilians. Each member further acknowledges that the Fire District as the authority having jurisdiction has both the legal right and responsibility to limit and control the dissemination of any information, images, or media content of any sort obtained during or through an individual's participation in firemanic activities or arising from the individual's affiliation with the Fire District or Fire Department. This Policy was enacted In order to preserve the privacy interests of members of the general public, the privacy interests of other members of the Fire Department and Fire District, and to promote the collegiality and the comradeship that make Quaker Springs Fire District #1 and Quaker Springs Volunteer Fire Department, Inc. a successful fire-fighting unit.

APPLICATION:

This Policy applies to all members, officers and agents of the Fire Department and all members, officers, and employees of the Fire District. This also applies to a member by extension with regard to any social media postings made by any person on behalf of a member or any person affiliated with a member for whom the member would be required to make a conflict of interest disclosure under relevant circumstances requiring disclosure of a potential conflict of interest pursuant to either the Fire District or Fire Department Codes of Ethics or Conflict of Interest Policies. For the following provisions of this Policy, all persons under any classifications of membership, employment, or affiliation are collectively referred to hereinafter as “members”.

POLICY:

THE PUBLICATION OR POSTING ON SOCIAL MEDIA OF ANY OF THE FOLLOWING THAT IS DONE WITHOUT THE EXPRESS PERMISSION OF THE BOARD OF FIRE COMMISSIONERS IS PROHIBITED:

THE FIRE DISTRICT’S OR FIRE DEPARTMENT’S:

- NAME,
- IMAGES (including, but not limited to: interior areas of fire stations, apparatus, logos, official designs and patches, call responses and activities, meetings training events and evolutions and members while on duty),
- LIKENESSES,
- ANY MEDIA OR ANY INFORMATION obtained or taken while a member was in the performance of firemanic duties

For purposes of this Policy “Firemanic Duties” are any activities occurring during the course of an official Fire District or Fire Department event including but not limited to those activities enumerated in Volunteer Firefighters’ Benefit Law Section 5 as well as any additional activities as designated by the Board or Chief.

Members may not utilize on their own personal social media any logos, drawings, trademarks, copyrights or other images or photographic media of events (including calls, training, or meetings, etc.), members, or equipment typically associated with or obtained in conjunction with Fire District activities or call responses without the express, prior-written approval of the Board of Fire Commissioners.

To the extent that members of Fire Department post comments to Social Media outside the scope of their firemanic or employment responsibilities, such members may not include any confidential information or personnel matters of the Fire District or Fire Department; may not violate any confidence or privilege; and may not make any statements that would give the impression that the views expressed by the member are the views, policies, or opinions of Fire District or are being made on behalf of the Fire District or Fire Department. Members should refrain from posting comments about any member, Fire District, fire department, fire district or fire company – especially mutual aid companies – on any such sites. Any grievances or complaints that a member has about Quaker Springs Fire District #1, Quaker Springs Volunteer Fire Department, Inc., or mutual aid departments should be made through the recognized normal channels such as the Fire District chain of command or the Fire District’s or Fire Department’s organizational structure, and not through Social Media. Members may not post to any on-line forums (including, but not limited to Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, Discord, etc.) creating the

impression that the posting is being done in an official or representative capacity for the Fire District. Members are prohibited from using or referencing any official Fire District e-mail address or official social media sites and are prohibited from providing links, redirection, or references to any official Fire District or Fire Department site from their personal account(s).

MEMBER'S REQUESTS FOR USE:

Members may request the permission from the Board of Fire Commissioners to use on their personal social media sites images or other information governed by this policy. Requests should be made in writing (email is acceptable) directed to the Board of Fire Commissioners (firedistrict@qsfd.com). The Board of Fire Commissioners shall consider the request and shall respond directly to the requesting member no later than the day immediately following the second Board of Fire Commissioner's Regular Meeting conducted after the request was submitted and received by the District Secretary or District Administrator. The Board may approve, deny, or approve with conditions or limitations the request.

POLICY VIOLATIONS:

A violation of this policy may be deemed to be misconduct, incompetence, insubordination, or violation of oath of office and serve as the basis for disciplinary action by the Fire District and/or Fire Department according to the Quaker Springs Fire District #1 Standards of Conduct Policy, the Quaker Springs Volunteer Fire Department, Inc. Bylaws, New York State General Municipal Law Section 209-L, or any other relevant Policy, directive, or order authorized by law. A violation of this Policy may result in discipline including up to suspension or termination of membership.

NOTE:

WWW.QSFD.COM, the Quaker Springs Fire Department Instagram page and the QUAKER SPRINGS VOLUNTEER FIRE DEPARTMENT Facebook page are the only official online presences for the District and Department. No other websites, Facebook pages, Twitter accounts, TikTok accounts or other Social Media platforms are to be setup without prior authorization and approval from the Board of Commissioners of the Fire District.